test your APIs by using Postman or another HTTP client.

You could use any of several tools to automatically generate a C# client from an OpenAPI description, such as OpenAPI Generator (http://mng.bz/Y1wB), but in this chapter I use NSwag. You may remember from section 11.1 that NSwag can be used instead of Swashbuckle to generate an OpenAPI description for your API. But unlike Swashbuckle, NSwag also contains a *client* generator. NSwag is also the default library used by both Visual Studio and the Microsoft .NET OpenAPI global tool to generate C# client code.

Code generation based on an OpenAPI description works via the process shown in figure 11.6. First, Visual Studio or the .NET tool downloads the OpenAPI description JSON file so that it's available locally. The code generation tool reads the OpenAPI description, identifies all the endpoints and schemas described by the document, and generates a C# client class that you can use to call the API described in the document. The code generation tool hooks into the build process so that any time the local OpenAPI description file changes, the code generator runs to regenerate the client.